BHUMI PEDNEKAR, *33*

Actress

"Gratification for me comes when people recognise, praise and love my work, whether it's an effort that I made on social media to advocate for environmental awareness or a character that I played on screen, like Sandhya of* Dum Laga Ke Haisha. *Despite how unusual and off-beat it was for a Hindi film heroine, I felt almost giddy with happiness that they found her to be an inspiration."



BANDEEP SINGH

BIBEK DEBROY, *67*

Economist and author

"Happiness is a state of mind. It has nothing to do with relationships with others, or with possession of material objects and status. Internally, happiness is linked with a state of being at peace, as the Bhagavad Gita also says. Therefore, the search for happiness is within and it requires some detachment from, and indifference to, the external world. I love the translations I do from Sanskrit to English and I am happy in their midst. They almost have a meditative function. And that state of happiness, while translating, seems to brush off on a general sense of warmth and well-being. People have written books about being happy. But the answer is always within."

YASIR IQBAL

